

# Connect All Data Sources Effectively

The last article on this subject, published in the July 2013 edition of *OSFY*, explored how to simultaneously get data from two PostgreSQL bases that have one ID in common. The second article in the series looks at more complex tasks, like fetching more data stored in plain HTML.



There are multiple datastores that accumulate the received goods into various warehouses. These goods are characterised by date of admission and by their condition. Due to the fact that we had a direct access to all databases like the parent warehouse, as well as the child warehouse, we were able to prepare a JSP-page that connects to both geographically remote PostgreSQL databases, by polling its content with the item's unique ID. The process was so simple, that we got the final result very fast (see Figure 1).

However, we also need to know the date when the goods come to the corporate warehouse. And here lies the real problem, because direct access to that HQ database is prohibited. Luckily, there's an automated export mechanism that creates a HTML page every night. This page contains all the items' IDs and corresponding data, like receipt dates. Such a page is freely accessed over the Internet, so everyone can download and analyse it. The format of such HTML page, to which all necessary details are exported, is as follows:

```
1. <tr class="style_5" valign="top">
2.   <td class="style_6" style="overflow:hidden;">
```

```
3.   <div>Flathead Screwdriver</div>
4.   </td>
5.   <td class="style_6" style="overflow:hidden;">
6.     <div>imported-class item</div>
7.   </td>
8.   <td class="style_6" style="overflow:hidden;">
9.     <div>00010000279379</div>
10.  </td>
11.  <td style="overflow:hidden;">
12.    <div>26.03.2013</div>
13.  </td>
14. </tr>
```

This is Listing 1. You can see the sample HTML code that contains the necessary data to fetch.

Please pay attention to lines 3, 9 and 12. They contain some key information. And that is exactly what we have to deal with in order to transform it correctly and add the unified statistics.

To get started, let's first prepare a small shell-script named *get\_hqdate.sh*, which will take as the input parameter our unique ID number, for example, 00010000279379. And as a